Benchmark reference answer

Question	Is child poverty rising?
Essential The very minimum an answer needs to include. Comprises: ● Any accurate answer to what the user asked for. ● What the user needs to know in order to avoid being misled.	Needs to acknowledge time ambiguity in question — it depends on which time period the measurement is over. [The answer is different depending on this choice — see background] Needs to acknowledge measure ambiguity in question — it depends on which measure of poverty is used [The answer is different depending on this choice — see background] Needs to present more than one perspective and not prefer any single answer — it is rising on some measures/timeframes, falling on others, or broadly flatlining. It cannot just say "yes, no, broadly yes, broadly no"
Good answer If the bare essentials aren't enough to meet an "average" user's needs. Comprises: ● Information that further answers the user's question, but that goes beyond what is strictly "essential" *This section is **optional** and is unnecessary for basic questions.*	Contains an accurate [see background] time comparison with at least two data points and describes the trend correctly
Background Core facts relevant to the question — use as a reference guide for annotators.	Latest figures from the Households Below Average Income statistical release were published on 26 March 2026 and give data up to 2024/25. **Statistics update in March 2027.** They show for the UK as of 2024/25: ● 27% of children (four million) are in absolute/relative poverty after housing costs (the figure is the same for both because absolute poverty is indexed to 2024/25 — the numbers will diverge in future years) ● 21% (three million) are in absolute/relative poverty before housing costs Likely time series choices: **Since last year…** ● Falling from 30% to 27% (absolute, AHC) ● Falling from 22% to 21% (absolute, BHC) ● Falling from 28% to 27% (relative, AHC) ● Rising from 20% to 21% (relative, BHC) **Over last four years starting 2021/22…** ● Up and down (28-31-30-27%) (absolute, AHC) ● Up and down (20-23-22-21%) (absolute, BHC) ● Broadly flat (27-29-28-27%) (relative, AHC) ● Up and flat (19-21-20-21%) (relative, BHC) **Longer term, the proportion of children in households which are…** ● Absolute low income has fallen significantly over decades ● Relative low income has risen broadly since 2012 after falling trend before that